

GRACIAS POR INVITAR, LIVING PROJECT PORTAL, SPRINT 1

Project Charter

Scope boundary, assumptions, constraints, milestones and the stakeholder register.

Version 0.1, Draft for team review, revised Sep 10, 2026

Owner To be assigned

Team Samuel Alderete, Jazmin Huerta, Christian Lopez-Matuleasy, Emmanuel Saenz, Oscar Vargas

Course CS 4390/5388 Software Project Management, The University of Texas at El Paso, Fall 2026

Web <https://gpi-portal.onrender.com/sprint-1/project-charter/>

DRAFT FOR TEAM REVIEW

The charter is the anchor document for every sprint after this one. The sections below carry the facts on record (team, dates, problem statement, research findings). Sections marked for team input need decisions only the team can make. Nothing marked as a draft should survive to the final version.

Project purpose

Gracias Por Invitar is a centralized hub for events in El Paso, from official events such as concerts and festivals to local ones such as farmers markets, car meets and card shows. Its purpose is that people find out about events before they happen instead of after. The name is the problem: "thanks for the invite" is what you say when the photos show up and nobody told you.

The project exists to satisfy the business objective set out in the Business Strategy, and it is being managed and documented sprint by sprint on this portal for CS 4390/5388 at The University of Texas at El Paso.

Problem statement

As tested in Sprint 1: *people find it hard to find events and places to go to in El Paso/Juárez, often finding out after the events have already happened.*

As refined by the research: people in El Paso find out about events after they have already happened, because announcements are scattered across dozens of social accounts and only reach the people already following the right ones. The Market Research holds the evidence.

Objectives

TEAM DECISION

Draft objectives for the team to confirm, cut or replace. They mirror the success measures in the Business Strategy.

1. Publish a public listing of events in El Paso, by date and category, that is more complete within its chosen categories than any single social account.
 2. Give organizers a way to submit events directly, so the listing does not depend on the team's own curation.
 3. Reach the two underserved groups the research identified: people who rely on word of mouth, and people with little or no social media.
 4. Keep a complete, public record of how the project is managed, on this portal, every sprint.
-

Scope boundary

In scope

- Events in El Paso, Texas.
- Both official and local events: concerts, festivals, sports, markets, car meets, card shows, comedy, races, trivia nights, kermeses and similar public gatherings.
- A date-first view: what is happening today, this weekend, this week.
- Categories and interest-based filtering, since three Phase 2 participants asked for it.
- A way for organizers to submit events.
- Lead time: events listed at least about a week ahead where the organizer's own announcement allows it.

Out of scope

- Ticketing, payments, or reselling.
- Social features: comments, RSVPs visible to friends, messaging.
- Private events and invitations.
- Organizer tooling beyond submission (no CRM, no analytics dashboards) in the first version.
- Recommendation or personalization engines. Filters are in scope; prediction is not.

Open scoping questions

TEAM DECISION

These came out of the research and need a decision before Sprint 2 estimates anything.

1. **Juárez.** Participants split: one wants both sides in one place, one does not cross at all, and most described El Paso only. The current boundary is El Paso; Juárez is a decision, not an assumption.
2. **Sourcing.** Organizer submissions, team curation, public posts, or a mix. This decides the product's effort profile more than any feature.
3. **First categories.** Which categories the listing is complete in on day one.
4. **First group served.** Word-of-mouth dependents or people without social media.

Deliverables

Management record (this portal), every sprint. Sprint 1: Market Research, Business Strategy, Project Charter, interview evidence. Sprint 2: business case, estimation appendix, ROI analysis, change log. Later sprints as released by the course. Every public document exists as a web page and as a PDF, and the private retrospective goes to Blackboard only.

Product.

TEAM DECISION

Define the product deliverable for the semester: a working web application, a prototype, or a plan and estimate only. The course guidelines describe the portal as the major deliverable; what the team commits to building is the team's call and drives every estimate in Sprint 2.

Assumptions

TEAM REVIEW

Drafted from the research. Each one is a thing the project will be wrong about if it is false; keep the ones the team believes and add the rest.

1. Event information for El Paso is publicly available (organizer posts, venue pages, city listings) and can be collected legitimately.
2. Organizers want more reach than their own followers and will submit events to a listing that gives it to them.
3. A weekly habit is possible: people will check one place for what is happening, as they once did with the listing page that stopped.
4. About a week of lead time is enough for most participants' planning, per Phase 2.
5. The team can build and run the listing on free or already-available hosting for the length of the semester.
6. The five team members remain available for the semester at the effort the course expects.

Constraints

- **Schedule.** Six sprints, each two weeks, deadlines fixed by the course (see milestones). Nothing slips.
- **Team.** Five students, part time, with other coursework.
- **Budget.** No project budget. Hosting for the portal must be free; product infrastructure is limited to free tiers and what the team already has.
- **Public record.** Everything except the retrospective and peer evaluations is public, sprint by sprint, and earlier pages are never replaced.
- **AI use.** Permitted for the website and for drafts the team reviews; not permitted for the individual reflections, the estimation memo, or any go/no-go reasoning. Every sprint carries a disclosure.

Stakeholder register

STAKEHOLDER	TYPE	INTEREST	INFLUENCE	HOW THEY ARE ENGAGED
Samuel Alderete	Team	Delivery of the project and the portal	High	Team member; role to be added
Jazmin Huerta	Team	Delivery of the project and the portal	High	Team member; role to be added
Christian Lopez-Matulesy	Team	Delivery of the project and the portal	High	Team member; role to be added
Emmanuel Saenz	Team	Delivery of the project and the portal	High	Team member; role to be added
Oscar Vargas	Team	Delivery of the project and the portal	High	Team member; role to be added
Course instructor, CS 4390/5388	Sponsor and evaluator	A well-managed project with a complete, defensible record	High	Sprint demos, portal reviews, Blackboard submissions
Peer teams	Reviewers	Gallery-walk feedback on Sprint 1	Low	Portal Debut Day feedback and the team's written response
Event-goers who rely on word of mouth	Customer	Finding out before, not after	Medium	Interviewed in Sprint 1; follow-up consent on record
Event-goers with little or no social media	Customer	A source that does not require an account	Medium	Interviewed in Sprint 1; follow-up consent on record
Organizers and venues	Supplier and customer	Reach beyond their own followers	High	Not yet engaged; sourcing decision pending

STAKEHOLDER	TYPE	INTEREST	INFLUENCE	HOW THEY ARE ENGAGED
Incumbent channels (Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, FitFam, Google, Ticketmaster)	Environment	None in the project	High on the market	Understood through the research; possible distribution partners
City of El Paso and its tourism accounts	Environment, possible partner	Visibility of official events	Medium	Not yet engaged

TEAM INPUT NEEDED

Add roles for each team member, and any stakeholder the team knows of that the research did not surface (a faculty advisor, a venue contact, a student organization).

Milestones

SPRINT	BLOCK	DUE	CONTENTS
1	Aug 25 to Sep 21	Mon, Sep 21, 2026, 11:59 PM	Market Research, Business Strategy, Project Charter, evidence
2	Sep 22 to Oct 5	Mon, Oct 5, 2026, 11:59 PM	Business case, estimation appendix, ROI, change log
3	Oct 6 to Oct 19	Mon, Oct 19, 2026, 11:59 PM	To be released
4	Oct 20 to Nov 2	Mon, Nov 2, 2026, 11:59 PM	To be released
5	Nov 3 to Nov 16	Mon, Nov 16, 2026, 11:59 PM	To be released
6	Nov 17 to Nov 30	Mon, Nov 30, 2026, 11:59 PM	To be released

Portal Debut Day is Tuesday, September 22. The final class session is Tuesday, December 1.

Initial risks

TEAM REVIEW

A starting register, drafted from the research and the constraints. The full risk register is developed in later sprints.

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	RESPONSE
Events cannot be sourced completely enough to beat a curated feed	High	High	Decide sourcing first; start narrow and be complete in a few categories
Nobody finds the hub (the discovery problem, one level up)	High	High	Distribution through organizers and the accounts people already follow
Scope grows toward Juárez, notifications, personalization	Medium	High	Hold the scope boundary; changes go through the change log
Uneven contribution across five members	Medium	Medium	Ownership named per page and per document; contribution statements every sprint
Sprint deadlines are fixed and short	Certain	Medium	Publish early; the portal is live before the deadline, not at it

Roles and responsibilities

TEAM INPUT NEEDED

Name who owns the portal, each document, the product work, and the Blackboard submissions. The guidelines require that every member can explain every page.

Approval

ROLE	NAME	DATE
Project team	<i>All five members</i>	<i>Pending</i>
Instructor acknowledgement		<i>Pending</i>

Generated from the portal source at build time. The web page and this PDF are two renders of the same document. Revision history: v0.1 (Sep 10, 2026) Structure drafted with the facts on record; sections needing team decisions are marked.